



AGAPAY

LOVE HOW YOU GIVE

PARISH ONBOARDING & OPERATIONS GUIDE

Stripe, Payouts & the AGAPAY Bookstore

A complete, practical guide for activating AGAPAY Giving, connecting Stripe, managing deposits, reconciling transactions, and adding parish commerce.

VERIFY	Parish EIN, legal information, and authorized representative
CONNECT	the parish's connected Stripe account and the parish bank account
LAUNCH	Giving funds, campaigns, calendar, link, and QR code
RECONCILE	Balances, payouts, transaction fees, and reports
SELL	AGAPAY Bookstore commerce with no AGAPAY transaction fee

OVERVIEW

Your AGAPAY Setup at a Glance

Most parishes can complete the initial setup in about 15–20 minutes once the required information is ready. Verification review may take longer if Stripe requests additional documentation.

What You'll Need

Item	What to Have Ready
Parish EIN / Tax ID	The parish or monastery federal Employer Identification Number.
Parish bank details	ACH routing number and checking-account number.
Organization information	Legal name, physical address, phone, email, and website or AGAPAY page.
Authorized representative	Name, home address, date of birth, phone, email, and government-issued ID.
AGAPAY invitation	The onboarding email or dashboard access supplied after parish verification.

The Five-Part Flow

- 1 Open the invitation**
Use the AGAPAY onboarding link and parish credentials.
- 2 Choose a plan**
Select the AGAPAY tier that matches the parish's needs and complete subscription checkout.
- 3 Connect Stripe**
Complete Stripe-hosted organization, representative, and bank verification.
- 4 Configure Giving**
Add funds and campaigns, select the liturgical calendar, and activate the page.
- 5 Review and reconcile**
Confirm a test gift, understand payout timing, and establish a monthly reconciliation routine.

IMPORTANT

Use a dedicated parish administrator account. Treat AGAPAY and Stripe access as financial access, and enable strong authentication wherever available.

PART 1

Invitation, Login & Subscription

Open the AGAPAY Invitation

After parish verification, AGAPAY provides access to the parish dashboard. The invitation should identify the parish account and direct the administrator to the setup workflow.

1 Open the dashboard link

Use the link in the AGAPAY onboarding email.

2 Sign in with the supplied credentials

Enter the parish identifier and temporary password, if one was provided.

3 Change the temporary password

Use a strong password known only to authorized parish personnel.

4 Begin the setup workflow

Complete billing before connecting Stripe when the dashboard presents the steps in that order.

AGAPAY Plans

Plans are chosen by capability rather than parish size — start simply and add Orthodox giving and stewardship tools as the parish is ready for them. Every tier can be upgraded, downgraded, or cancelled at any time.

Plan	Monthly Fee	Best Fit
Starter	\$9/month	Simple online giving — one general fund, one-time and recurring gifts, basic history and receipts.
Giving Plus	\$49/month	Orthodox giving tools — custom funds, campaigns, commemorations, statements, liturgical calendar, QR tools.
Stewardship	\$99/month	Adds stewardship insight — pledge tracking, donor history, Stewardship Health, and Bookstore payments.
Parish	\$149/month	Complete parish operations — Directory, Sacraments & Services, full Parish Commerce, Text-to-Give.
Cathedral / Diocese	Custom	301+ households, cathedrals, and diocesan use — multi-parish dashboard, white-label options.
Monastic	\$0/month	Monasteries, sketes, and convents — all Giving Plus features, free, forever.

NOTE

AGAPAY does not charge a donation transaction fee on any tier. Only Stripe's standard payment processing applies to gifts — see Part 6 for the full breakdown.

PART 2

Connect the Parish Stripe Account

Stripe hosts the sensitive onboarding and verification process. AGAPAY does not require the parish to create an unrelated standard Stripe account first.

Complete the Stripe Onboarding Sections

- 1 Organization or business type**
Select the option that accurately reflects the parish's actual legal organization. Do not guess.
- 2 Legal organization information**
Enter the legal name, address, phone, email, and website exactly as supported by parish records.
- 3 Tax identification**
Enter the parish EIN. Do not substitute a personal Social Security number for the parish EIN.
- 4 Authorized representative**
Provide the requested personal information for an authorized priest, treasurer, council officer, or other representative.
- 5 Bank account**
Enter a parish-owned checking account for payouts.
- 6 Identity documentation**
Upload a clear, current government-issued ID if Stripe requests it.
- 7 Review and submit**
Check every entry carefully and submit the account for verification.

IMPORTANT

Stripe may verify the account quickly or request additional documents. Payouts can remain paused until all required information is accepted.

TIP

If an onboarding link is expired or unavailable, return to AGAPAY and generate or request a fresh Stripe connection link.

PART 3

Verification & Bank Account Controls

Verification Checklist

- Legal name matches parish and IRS records.
- EIN is entered correctly.
- Representative information is complete and accurate.
- Uploaded documents are clear, current, and uncropped.
- The payout account belongs to the parish or monastery.
- Every Stripe alert has been reviewed and resolved.

Adding the Payout Account

- 1 Open the parish's Stripe Dashboard**
Launch the connected account from the AGAPAY dashboard.
- 2 Find payout or bank settings**
Stripe labels may include Bank Accounts, External Accounts, Payout Details, or Settings.
- 3 Enter verified bank information**
Use the ACH routing number and parish account number from official bank records.
- 4 Complete bank verification**
Stripe may verify instantly or use another verification method.
- 5 Confirm the first successful payout**
Do not close an old bank account until a payout has successfully reached the new account.

IMPORTANT

Closing the old bank account before updating Stripe can cause failed payouts and delayed access to funds.

Where to Find the Numbers

Source	Routing Number	Account Number
Paper check	Usually the left-most 9-digit number	Usually the center number; length varies
Online banking	Account details or routing information	Account details or full account information
Bank support	Ask for the ACH routing number	Ask for the checking or DDA account number

PART 4

Configure & Launch the Giving Page

Once Stripe is connected and the account is able to receive payments, complete the parish-facing giving setup before distributing the link or QR code.

Pre-Launch Configuration

Configuration	Recommended Action
Designated Funds	Add General Stewardship and any other active restricted or designated funds.
Giving Campaigns	Create active parish needs, appeals, or time-limited campaigns.
Feast-aware Giving	Enable the relevant feast offerings and confirm the parish calendar.
Liturgical Calendar	Select Julian or Revised Julian according to parish practice.
Giving Page Status	Set the page to Active only after the content and Stripe status are ready.
QR Code and Link	Download the QR code and test both the code and direct giving-page URL.

Run a Test

- 1 Open the public giving page**
Use a private browser window or another device.
- 2 Make a small test gift**
Confirm that the form completes successfully.
- 3 Verify the transaction**
Confirm that the payment appears in AGAPAY and Stripe.
- 4 Confirm the fund designation**
Make sure the gift is attributed to the intended fund or campaign.
- 5 Confirm payout readiness**
Check that the Stripe account shows no unresolved restrictions.

TIP

Do not share the QR code broadly until the public page, receipt flow, fund designation, and dashboard record have all been tested.

PART 5

Balances, Payouts & Reconciliation

Understanding the Balance

Status	Meaning	Next Step
Pending	Payment has been received but is not yet available for payout.	Wait for Stripe clearance and any review period.
Available	Funds have cleared and are ready for payout.	Included in the next scheduled payout.
In Transit	Stripe has initiated the bank deposit.	Wait for the bank to post the deposit.
Paid	The payout has reached the parish bank account.	Reconcile the bank deposit to the included transactions.

Payout Schedules

Schedule	How It Works	Practical Consideration
Daily	Available funds are paid on eligible business days.	Fast access; more bank deposits.
Weekly	Available funds accumulate for a weekly payout.	Fewer deposits to reconcile.
Monthly	Available funds accumulate for a monthly payout.	May fit monthly bookkeeping.
Manual	Funds remain until a payout is initiated.	Use only for a defined accounting reason.

NOTE

Available payout controls depend on AGAPAY's Stripe configuration. If the schedule control is not shown in the Stripe Dashboard, contact AGAPAY support.

Monthly Reconciliation Routine

- Export AGAPAY and Stripe transaction activity when available.
- Match each bank deposit to the related Stripe payout.
- Confirm gross gifts, total fees, refunds, disputes, and net deposits.
- Review restricted and designated gifts separately.
- Investigate unmatched deposits or missing transactions promptly.

PART 6

Donation Fees: What the Parish Receives

AGAPAY charges no donation transaction fee on any plan. Every gift is processed by Stripe and flows directly to the parish's own connected Stripe account — the only cost involved is Stripe's standard payment processing.

How the Fee Works

Component	Standard Domestic Online Card Gift	Recipient
Stripe processing portion	Approximately 2.9% + \$0.30	Stripe
AGAPAY donation fee	\$0 — on every tier	—
Net to parish	Donation minus Stripe processing only	Parish bank account

Example Gifts

	\$25 Gift	\$100 Gift	\$250 Gift
Donor gives	\$25.00	\$100.00	\$250.00
Approx. Stripe processing (2.9% + \$0.30)	-\$1.03	-\$3.20	-\$7.55
AGAPAY donation fee	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Net to parish	\$23.97	\$96.80	\$242.45

IMPORTANT

Do not apply an additional AGAPAY percentage on top of Stripe's processing cost. AGAPAY does not take a share of donations on any current plan — Stripe's processing fee is the only deduction.

TIP

Donors can choose to cover Stripe's processing cost at checkout so the parish receives the full intended gift. This option is available on every plan.

PART 7

Stripe's Nonprofit Discounted Processing

Stripe offers discounted processing fees to eligible nonprofit organizations whose Stripe account is used primarily to receive donations. This is a Stripe-administered program, requested directly with Stripe — AGAPAY does not enroll the parish automatically.

Published Discounted Rate

Payment Method	Standard Stripe Rate	Nonprofit Rate
Card	Approximately 2.9% + \$0.30	2.2% + \$0.30
ACH / bank debit	0.8%, capped at \$5	0.8%, capped at \$5

NOTE

Discounted rates are granted per Stripe account after review and are not guaranteed or published on a fixed schedule. Confirm the current rate with Stripe directly when the parish's account is approved.

Eligibility Criteria

- The organization is registered as a nonprofit with valid tax documentation confirming that status.
- The organization operates in an eligible region (includes the United States and Canada).
- At least 80% of the organization's Stripe payment volume comes from tax-deductible donations.

IMPORTANT

Membership fees, tuition payments, ticket sales, registration fees, and auction payments do not count toward the 80% donation threshold. A parish running significant Bookstore, event, or Sacraments & Services volume through the same Stripe account should confirm those totals still leave giving at 80% or more before applying.

Documents Stripe Requires

Requirement	What to Provide
Donation volume confirmation	A statement confirming that over 80% of the account's payment volume comes from tax-deductible donations.
Tax registration details	The parish EIN or IRS confirmation letter for 501(c)(3) status.
Tax-exempt documentation	Valid tax documentation verifying the parish's nonprofit status.

How to Request the Discount

- 1 Sign in to the connected Stripe account**
Use the credentials for the Stripe account linked to AGAPAY.
- 2 Open a support request with Stripe**
Contact Stripe support to request nonprofit pricing for the account.
- 3 Provide account details**
Include the Stripe Account ID and the registered email address on the account.
- 4 Attach the required documentation**
Donation volume confirmation, EIN or IRS determination letter, and tax-exempt documentation.
- 5 Wait for Stripe's review**
Stripe confirms eligibility and applies the discounted rate to the account once approved.

TIP

This discount applies to Stripe's own processing fee and stacks with AGAPAY's \$0 donation fee — approval lowers the parish's total cost per gift without changing anything on the AGAPAY side.

PART 8

AGAPAY Bookstore & Parish Commerce

Bookstore and Parish Commerce tools are now built into the Stewardship and Parish tiers — there is no separate add-on subscription to manage.

Where Bookstore Access Lives

Stewardship

\$99/mo

Bookstore payments for parish goods, plus stewardship insight and reporting.

Parish

\$149/mo

Full Parish Commerce workflows — Bookstore, parish goods, and event-style payments.

Cathedral / Diocese

Custom

Everything in Parish, extended across a multi-parish or diocesan dashboard.

Bookstore Fees

Item	Cost or Fee	What It Means
AGAPAY commerce transaction fee	\$0	AGAPAY takes no percentage or per-order fee on Bookstore sales.
Stripe processing	Applicable Stripe processing fees	Stripe may still charge its normal payment-processing costs.
Net commerce proceeds	Sale minus Stripe processing, refunds, and applicable adjustments	Deposited through the connected Stripe account.

KEY POINT

The donation fee model and the Bookstore fee model are the same on this point: AGAPAY charges \$0 on both. Only Stripe's standard processing applies either way.

Bookstore Operations

- Add books or parish merchandise with names and prices.
- Review customer, item, quantity, sales amount, taxes collected, refunds, and net activity.
- Keep commerce income separate from charitable contributions in parish bookkeeping.
- Reconcile Bookstore orders against Stripe payment activity and bank payouts.
- Preserve receipts and order records for accounting and sales-tax purposes.

Weekly Treasurer Summary

When enabled, the parish may receive a weekly Bookstore summary showing items sold, purchasers, item prices, total sales, taxes collected, and other useful reconciliation details. Confirm the current dashboard settings and recipient email before relying on the report.

PART 9

Records, Refunds, Disputes & Tax Notes

Refunds and Disputes

- Refunds reduce the available Stripe balance and may reduce a future payout.
- Disputes or chargebacks require prompt review and supporting records.
- Keep donor communications, receipts, order details, and fulfillment records.
- A negative Stripe balance may be offset against later incoming funds or payouts.

Charitable Gifts vs. Commerce

Activity	Bookkeeping Treatment
Donation	Record as a charitable contribution according to parish accounting policies and applicable law.
Bookstore sale	Record as commerce revenue, including sales price, applicable sales tax, refunds, and processing costs.
Mixed activity	Avoid treating a purchase as a charitable gift merely because it occurs through a parish platform.

TAX NOTE

Tax forms and reporting depend on the Stripe Connect configuration, transaction type, federal rules, and state requirements. A Form 1099-K reports gross processed payment activity; it does not determine whether the underlying funds are taxable. Consult the parish accountant or tax adviser.

Sales Tax

The parish is responsible for determining whether Bookstore products are taxable, registering when required, setting the correct tax treatment, filing returns, and remitting collected tax. AGAPAY is a software platform and does not replace parish-specific legal or tax advice.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Common Issues & Practical Responses

Stripe account is under review

- Open the parish's Stripe Dashboard and read every alert.
- Check the representative email for document requests.
- Confirm the legal name and EIN match official records.
- Upload only clear, current documents.
- Contact AGAPAY when the request is unclear.

Payouts are not arriving

- Confirm funds are available rather than pending.
- Verify the payout bank account and account status.
- Review payout dates, banking holidays, and expected arrival.
- Check for negative balances, refunds, disputes, or verification restrictions.

Giving page is paused or hidden

- Confirm the AGAPAY subscription is active.
- Confirm Stripe shows the account as able to accept payments and receive payouts.
- Set the Giving Page Status to Active.
- Test the public URL in a private browser window.

A dashboard or setup link does not work

- Return to the parish dashboard and request a fresh link when possible.
- Check spam and filtered email folders.
- Use the authorized parish email address when contacting support.
- Include the parish name, parish identifier, screenshot, and exact error message.

SECURITY

Never send full bank-account numbers, passwords, full Social Security numbers, or unredacted identity documents by ordinary email.

FINAL CHECKLIST

Before You Share the Giving Link or Open the Bookstore

- ☐ AGAPAY subscription is active on the intended plan.
- ☐ Stripe account can accept payments and receive payouts.
- ☐ Parish bank account is verified.
- ☐ At least one designated fund is configured.
- ☐ Liturgical calendar and feast-aware settings are correct.
- ☐ Giving Page Status is Active.
- ☐ Dashboard password has been changed and securely stored.
- ☐ Giving link and QR code have been tested.
- ☐ A test donation appears correctly in AGAPAY and Stripe.
- ☐ Stewardship tier or higher is active before Bookstore use.
- ☐ Bookstore products, prices, taxes, and receipt flow have been tested.
- ☐ Treasurer understands that AGAPAY charges \$0 on donations and Bookstore sales — only Stripe processing applies.
- ☐ Nonprofit discounted processing requested with Stripe, if the parish is eligible (see Part 7).

Get Help

Email Support	Parish Dashboard	AGAPAY Website
support@agapay.app	agapay.app/parish/dashboard	agapay.app

God grant your parish many years of fruitful stewardship.

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